Global Ocean Accounts Partnership

What are ocean accounts?

Ocean accounts are **integrated records of regularly compiled and comparable data concerning ocean environment conditions** (e.g. extent/condition of mangroves), economic activity (e.g. sale of fish) and social conditions (e.g. coastal employment).

They align with existing international accounting standards and frameworks and retain a similar structure to national accounts maintained by national statistical offices or finance ministries.

Why ocean accounts matter

Ocean knowledge and data are fragmented across sectors and institutions and a lack of standardisation limits the ability to collate data in a coherent and transparent manner. This is where ocean accounts come in – **they provide an integrated foundation of information to inform evidence-based decision making and holistic policy development for blue economy and sustainable ocean planning and management approaches.**

Ocean accounts integrate four key components:

1. Macro-economic accounts from which economic measures such as GDP are derived and legal, illegal, unreported and unregulated activities can be accounted for.
2. Environmental-economic accounts that link assets and flows, wastes and expenditures, taxes and subsidies.
3. Ecosystem accounts which agree on a spatial framework for the extent, condition, biodiversity, services and value of ecosystems.
4. Structures data on ocean beneficiaries, technology, governance and management.

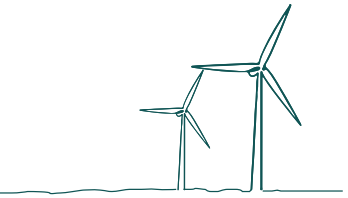
By integrating multiple data sets from a range of sources into a common information infrastructure, ocean accounts enable countries and stakeholders to:

- **Track the size**, condition and changing structure of the ocean economy.
- **Re-enforce** evidence-based decision-making for ocean planning and management to balance the sustainable use of the marine ecosystem across multiple sectors and stakeholders.
- **Activate** private sector financing in the ocean economy and ecosystem restoration projects.
- **Identify** who is benefitting from the ocean economy (e.g. through ocean-related income, employment and welfare).
- **Organise**, present, and communicate information in manner that decision-makers can easily understand (e.g. as dashboards or scenarios).
- **Support** and enhance international reporting by identifying comparable, headline indicators that include environmental and social dimensions.

Measuring and managing progress towards ocean sustainable development

The Global Ocean Accounts Partnership (GOAP) is **multistakeholder partnership** established to enable countries and other stakeholders to go Beyond GDP to measure and manage progress towards sustainable ocean development using ocean accounts. The Partnership is Co-chaired by the Ministry of Marine Affairs and Fisheries (Kementerian Kelautan dan Perikanan Republik Indonesia), Indonesia and Charles Darwin Foundation for the Galapagos Islands, Ecuador.

GOAP brings together governments, international organisations and research institutions to build a global community of practice for ocean accounting to ensure that the diverse values of the ocean are recognised in all decision making related to social and economic development.



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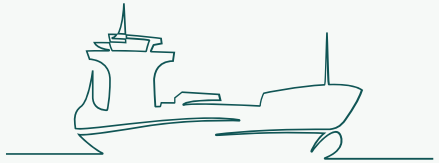
What we do

Accelerate and implement the 2030 Sustainable Development Agenda including SDG 14 (life below water), targets 15.9 (valuing nature in decision-making) and 17.19 (measurement of progress complementing GDP).

Support the High Level Panel for a Sustainable Ocean Economy's commitments to 100% sustainable management of national waters and associated sustainable ocean plans.

Support available from GOAP



GOAP supports Members and non-Members in the development of pilot ocean accounts and application of these to blue economy and sustainable marine management approaches. Using a country-led approach is at the centre of the GOAP delivery model and ensures bespoke support matched with the specific needs and policy objectives of each country.

Assist in sourcing financial or in-kind support for the development and implementation of ocean accounting initiatives.

Advisory support and technical guidance on linking ocean accounts with broader ocean policy objectives.

Catalyse and connect ocean accounts experts to host workshops and capacity building events and establish a Global Expert Panel to facilitate the creation of new knowledge to advance the development and global uptake of ocean accounting.

Provide a communication and collaboration platform for the global community of practice, and Communities of Practice in Africa, Pacific, Americas and Europe, to engage in mutual capacity development and share knowledge on ocean accounting.